Module 1

Organizational Behaviour

MODULE-1

ORGANISATIONAL BEHAVIOUR

INTRODUCTION

All organizations, be the business, educational or government, are social systems. They are run by people. The functioning of an organization depend upon how people work or behave in the organization. Human behaviour in organizations is highly unpredictable. It is unpredictable because it arises from people's deep-seated needs and value systems. However, it can be partially understood in terms of the framework of behavioral science, management and other disciplines. There is no idealistic solution to organizational problems. All that can be done is to increase our understanding and skills so that human relations at work can be enhanced.

ORGNISATIONAL BEHAVIOUR – CONCEPTS

Organizational Behavior is concerned with the study of human behaviour at work. It is the field of study that investigates the impact that individuals, groups and structure have on behavior within organization. It is the study and application of knowledge about how people act within organizations. It is a human tool for human benefit. It applies broadly to the behavior of people in all types of organizations, such as business, government, schools and services organizations. It covers three determinants of behavior in organizations: individuals, groups, and structure. OB is an applied field. It applies the knowledge gained about individuals, and the effect of structure on behavior, in order to make organizations work more effectively. OB covers the core topics of motivation, leadership behavior and power, interpersonal communication, group structure and process, learning, attitude development and perception, change process, conflict, job design and work stress.

DEFINITION:

According to **Callahan**, "Organizational behaviour is about of management activities concerned with understanding, predicting and influencing individual behaviour in organizational setting."

According to **Raman J. Aldag**, "Organizational behaviour i a branch of social science that eek to build theories that can be applied in predicting ,understanding and controlling behaviour in work organization.

In the opinion of **Robbins**, "OB is a field of study that investigates the impact that individual, group,

KEY ELEMENTS OF ORGANISATIONAL BEHAVIOUR:

There are four key elements in organizational behavior. There are people, structure, technology and the environment. Each o f the four elements o f organizational behavior will be

considered briefly.

1. People

People make up the internal social system of the organization. They consist of individuals and groups, and large groups as well as small ones. People are the living, thinking, feelings beings who created the organizations. It exists to achieve their objectives. Organizations exist to serve people. People do not exist to serve organizations. The work force is one of the critical resources that need to be managed. In managing human resources.

2. Structure

Structure defines the official relationships of people in organizations. Different jobs are required to accomplish all of an organization's activities. There are managers and employees, accountants and assemblers. These people have to be related in some structural way so that their work can be effective. The main structure relates to power and to duties. For example, one person has authority to make decisions that affect the work of other people.

3. Technology

Organizations have technologies for transforming inputs and outputs. These technologies consist of physical objects, activities and process, knowledge, all of which are brought to bear on raw materials, labour and capital inputs during a transformation process. The core technology is that set of productive components most directly associated with the transformation process.
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4. Environment

All organizations operate within an external environment. A single organization does not exist alone. It is part of a larger system that contains thousand of other elements. All these mutually influence each other in a complex system that becomes the life style of the people. Individual organization, such as a factory or school cannot escape from being influenced by this external environment. It influences the attitudes of people, affects working conditions, and provides competition for resources and power. Every organization interacts with other members of its environment. The interactions allow the organization t o acquire raw material, hire employees, secure capital, obtain knowledge, and build, lease or buy facilities and equipment. Since the organization process a product or service for consumption by the environment, it will also interact with its customers.

BASIC APPROACHES OF ORGANISATIONAL BEHAVIOR

i) **An Interdisciplinary Approach:** It is integrating many disciplines. It integrates social sciences and other disciplines that can contribute to the Organizational Behavior. It draws from these disciplines any ideas that will improve the relationships between people and organization. Its interdisciplinary nature is similar to that of medicine, which applies physical, biological and social science into a workable medical practice. Organizations must have people, and people

working toward goals must have organizations, so it is desirable to treat the two as a working unit.

ii)Scientific Management Approach: The fundamental concern of the scientific management school was to increase the efficiency of the worker basically through good job design and appropriate training of the workers. Taylor is the father of the scientific management movement and he developed many ides to increase organizational efficiency. Taylor showed that through proper job design, worker selection, employee training and incentives, productivity can be increased. The scientific management school advocated that efficiency can be attained by finding the right methods to get the job done, through specialization on the job, by planning and scheduling, by using standard operating mechanisms, establishing standard times to do the job, by proper selection and training of personnel and through wage incentives.

iii)A Human Resources (Supportive) Approach: It is developmental approach concerned with the growth and development of people toward higher levels of competency creativity and fulfillment, because people are the central resource in any organizations and any society. It helps people grow in self-control and responsibility and then it tries to create a climate in which all employees may contribute to the limits of their improved abilities. It is assumed that expanded capabilities and opportunities for people will lead directly to improvements in operating effectiveness. Work satisfaction will be a direct result when employees make fuller use of their capabilities. Essentially, the human resources approach means that better people achieve better results.

iv)A Contingency Approach: Traditional management relies on one basic principle – there is one best way of managing things and these things can be applied across the board in all the instances. The situational effect will be totally ignored in this traditional management. Situations are much more complex than first perceived and the different variables may require different behavior which means that different environments required different behavior for effectiveness. Each situation much be analyzed carefully to determine the significant variables that exist in order to establish the kinds of practices that will be more effective.

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v)A Systems Approach: This implies that organization consists of many inter related and inter dependent elements affecting one another in order to achieve the overall results. Conceptually a system implies that there are a multitude of variables in organization and that each of them affects all the others in complex relationships. An event that appears to affect one individual or one department actually may have significant influences elsewhere in the organization. Systems theorists describe the organization as “open to its external environment”, receiving certain inputs from the environment such as human resources, raw materials etc, and engaging in various operations to transform those raw materials into a finished products and finally turning out the “outputs” in its final form to be sent to the environment. The organization, since it is open to the environment, also receives feedback from the environment and takes corrective action as necessary.

NEED FOR STUDING ORGANISATIONAL BEHAVIOUR

- Organisational behaviour provides a sound work environment.
- It helps in creating effective leaders.
- It improves interpersonal relations.

- It maintains cordial industrial relation.
- It improves motivation and communication.
- It helps in creating congenial Organisational climate.

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CHALLENGES AND OPPORTUNITIES FOR ORGANISATIONAL BEHAVIOUR

INTRODUCTION

There are many challenges and opportunities for managers to use Organizational Behavior concepts to enhance the overall effectiveness of individuals, groups and organization. The following are some of the critical issues confronting managers for which the knowledge of Organizational Behavior offers worthy solutions based on behavioral science and other interdisciplinary fields.

NEW CHALLENGES FOR OB MANAGER

The following are some of the significant problems:

1. Improving People Skills
2. Improving Quality and Productivity
3. Managing Workforce Diversity
4. Responding to Globalization
5. Empowering People
6. Coping with Temporariness
7. Stimulating Innovation and Change
8. Improving Ethical Behavior

1.Improving People Skills:

Technological changes, structural changes, environmental changes are accelerated at a faster rate in business field. Unless employees and executives are equipped to possess the required skills to adapt those changes, the achievement of the targeted goals cannot be achieved in time. There two different categories of skills – managerial skills and technical skills. Some of the managerial skills include listening skills, motivating skills, planning and organizing skills, leading skills, problem solving skill, decision making skills etc. These skills can be enhanced by organizing a series of training and development programmes, career development programmes, induction and socialization etc.

Implications for Managers:

Designing an effective performance appraisal system with built-in training facilities will help upgrade the skills of the employees to cope up the demands of the external environment. The lower level cadre in management is required to possess more of technical skills. As they move towards upward direction, their roles will be remarkably changed and expected to have more of human relations and conceptual skills.

ii) Improving Quality and Productivity:

Quality is the extent to which the customers or users believe the product or service surpasses their needs and expectations. For example, a customer who purchases an automobile has certain expectation, one of which is that the automobile engine will start when it is turned on. If the engine fails to start, the customer's expectations will not have been met and the customer will perceive the quality of the car as poor. Deming defined quality as a predictable degree of uniformity and dependability, at low cost and suited to the market. Juran defined it as fitness for use.

Implications for Managers:

Today's managers understand that any efforts to improve quality and productivity must influence their employees. These employees will not only be a major force in carrying out changes, but increasingly will participate actively in planning those changes. Managers will put maximum effort in meeting the customer's requirements by involving everyone from all the levels and across all functions. Regular communications (both formally and informally) with all the staff at all levels is must. Two way communications at all levels must be promoted. Identifying training needs and relating them with individual capabilities and requirements is must. Top management's participation and commitment and a culture of continuous improvement must be established.

iii) Managing Workforce Diversity:

This refers to employing different categories of employees who are heterogeneous in terms of gender, race, ethnicity, relation, community, physically disadvantaged, homosexuals, elderly people etc. The primary reason to employ heterogeneous category of employees is to tap the talents and potentialities, harnessing the innovativeness, obtaining synergetic effect among the divorce workforce. In general, employees wanted to retain their individual and cultural identity, values and life styles even though they are working in the same organization with common rules and regulations. The major challenge for organizations is to become more accommodating to diverse groups of people by addressing their different life styles, family needs and work styles.

Implications for Managers:

Managers have to shift their philosophy from treating everyone alike to recognizing individual differences and responding to those differences in ways that will ensure employee retention and greater productivity while, at the same time not discriminating. If work force diversity is managed more effectively, the management is likely to acquire more benefits such as creativity and innovation as well as improving decision making skills by providing different perspectives on problems. If diversity is not managed properly and showed biases to favor only a few categories of employees, there is potential for higher turnover, more difficulty in communicating and more interpersonal conflicts.

iv) Responding to Globalization:

Today's business is mostly market driven; wherever the demands exist irrespective of distance, locations, climatic conditions, the business operations are expanded to gain their market share and to remain in the top rank etc. Business operations are no longer restricted to a particular locality or region. Company's products or services are spreading across the nations using mass communication, internet, faster transportation etc. An Australian wine producer now sells more wine through the Internet than through outlets across the country. More than 95% of Nokia hand phones are being sold outside of their home country Finland. Japanese cars are being sold in different parts of globe. Sri Lankan tea is exported to many cities across the globe. Executives of Multinational Corporation are very mobile and move from one subsidiary to another more frequently.

Implications for Managers:

Globalization affects a managerial skills in at least two ways: i) an Expatriate manager have to manage a workforce that is likely to have very different needs, aspirations and attitudes from the ones that they are used to manage in their home countries. ii) Understanding the culture of local people and how it has shaped them and accordingly learn to adapt ones management style to these differences is very critical for the success of business operations. One of the main personality traits required for expatriate managers is to have sensitivity to understand the individual differences among people and exhibit tolerance to it.

v) Empowering People:

The main issue is delegating more power and responsibility to the lower level cadre of employees and assigning more freedom to make choices about their schedules, operations, procedures and the method of solving their work-related problems. Encouraging the employees to participate in work related decision will sizably enhance their commitment at work. Empowerment is defined as putting employees in charge of what they do by eliciting some sort of ownership in them. Managers are doing considerably further by allowing employees full control of their work. An increasing number of organizations are using self-managed teams, where workers operate largely without boss. Due to the implementation of empowerment concepts across all the levels, the relationship between managers and the employees is reshaped. Managers will act as coaches, advisors, sponsors, facilitators and help their subordinates to do their task with minimal guidance.

Implications for Manager:

The executive must learn to delegate their tasks to the subordinates and make them more responsible in their work. And in so doing, managers have to learn how to give up control and employees have to learn how to take responsibility for their work and make appropriate decision. If all the employees are empowered, it drastically changes the type of leadership styles, power relationships, the way work is designed and the way organizations are structured.

vi) Coping with 'Temporariness:

In recent times, the Product life cycles are slimming, the methods of operations are improving, and fashions are changing very fast. In those days, the managers needed to introduce major change programs once or twice a decade. Today, change is an ongoing activity for most managers. The concept of continuous improvement implies constant change. In yester years, there used to be a long period of stability and occasionally interrupted by short period of change, but at present the change process is an ongoing activity due to competitiveness in developing new products and services with better features. Everyone in the organization faces today is one of permanent temporariness. The actual jobs that workers perform are in a permanent state of flux. So, workers need to continually update their knowledge and skills to perform new job requirements.

Implications for Manager:

Managers and employees must learn to cope with temporariness. They have to learn to live with flexibility, spontaneity, and unpredictability. The knowledge of Organizational Behavior will help understand better the current state of a work world of continual change, the methods of overcoming resistance to change process, the ways of creating a better organizational culture that facilitates change process etc.

vii) Stimulating Innovation and Change:

Today's successful organizations must foster innovation and be proficient in the art of change; otherwise they will become candidates for extinction in due course of time and vanished from their field of business. Victory will go to those organizations that maintain flexibility, continually improve their quality, and beat the competition to the market place with a constant stream of innovative products and services. For example, Compaq succeeded by creating more powerful personal computers for the same or less money than IBNM or Apple, and by putting their products to market quicker than the bigger competitors. Amazon.com is putting a lot of independent bookstores out of business as it proves you can successfully sell books from an Internet website.

Implications for Managers:

Some of the basic functions of business are being displaced due to the advent of a new systems and procedures. For example – books are being sold only through internet. Internet selling an organization's employees can be the impetus for innovation and change; otherwise they can be a major hindrance. The challenge for managers is to stimulate employee creativity and tolerance for change.

viii) Improving Ethical behavior:

The complexity in business operations is forcing the workforce to face ethical dilemmas, where they are required to define right and wrong conduct in order to complete their assigned activities. For example, Should the employees of chemical company blow the whistle if they uncover the discharging its untreated effluents into the river are polluting its water resources? Do

managers give an inflated performance evaluation to an employee they like, knowing that such an evaluation could save that employee's job?

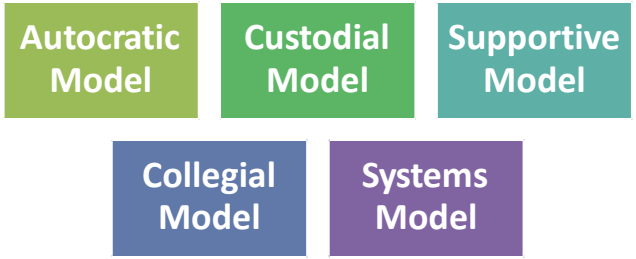
The ground rules governing the constituents of good ethical behavior has not been clearly defined. Differentiating right things from wrong behavior has become more blurred. Following unethical practices have become a common practice such as successful executives who use insider information for personal financial gain, employees in competitor business participating in massive cover-ups of defective products etc.

Implications for Managers:

Managers must evolve code of ethics to guide employees through ethical dilemmas. Organizing seminars, workshops, training programs will help improve ethical behavior of employees. Retaining consultants, lawyers, voluntary service organizations to assist the company in dealing with ethical issues will ensure positive ethical behavior. Managers need to create an ethically healthy climate for his employees where they can do their work productively and confront a minimal degree of ambiguity regarding what constitutes right and wrong behavior.

MODELS OF ORGANIZATIONAL BEHAVIOR:

We will look at five models of organizational behavior in this course.



AUTOCRATIC MODEL:

- This model depends on **power.** The manager has the power to demand "you do this or else" – and an employee who does not follow orders is punished.
- The manager has formal, official, **authority** over employees.
- This model assumes that employees have to be directed and pushed into doing the work. In this model, management does the thinking, employees obey orders and depend on the manager. Employees are tightly controlled. The manager can hire, fire and "perspire" them. Employees may obey managers but employees may not respect management.

Typically, employees receive minimum pay for minimum expected performance. Employees may have lower skills. Often, employees work in the authority model because they *have to*….to provide subsistence for themselves and their families.

Its weakness is that it leads to "**micro management**" **With micro management**, managers control all details of daily operations. Managers control time and processes, they put their needs above those of employees, they insist on complicated approval processes for even the smallest things and closely monitor all results.

The problem with the **autocratic model** and micro management is that it leads to low employee morale, poor decision-making (no one will make a decision because he/ she is afraid of the decision being over turned) and high turnover. As well, employees kept quiet about hating the workplace, they certainly made their feelings known at home and in the community.

This model can get things done but it has high human costs. It can be useful in crisis situations, within armies or with short-term employees.

CUSTODIAL MODEL

In the late 1800's, employers realized that employees might work better if their basic needs more satisfied, if they were more secure and had a better quality of work life. This was called **paternalism-** taking care of employees by providing them with benefits to meet their security needs.

The **custodial** approach depends on economic resources – money for wages and benefits - to motivate employees. The company has to have enough money to cover these costs. By the 1930's most employers were offering welfare programs…for example, housing, medical care and insurance, fewer working hours sick pay, pensions and paid vacation time off.

The problem with the **custodial model** is that it leads to dependence on the organization by the employee because of the security offered. Employees do not want to leave the organization, not so much because they like the job, but because they like or depend on the benefits that go with it. They cannot afford to quit.

In this model, employees may focus on economic rewards. They may be reasonable content, but may not be highly motivated – just passively cooperative.

Companies that adopt the **custodial** approach normally have a lower staff turnover. However, employees do not produce their best work and are not motivated to grow to their full potential. The **custodial model** is a good foundation for organizations to grow to the next approach.

SUPPORTIVE MODEL

It depends on leadership, not authority or money. Through leadership, managers provide a work situation in which employees can develop.

The **supportive model** assumes that employees want to work and will take responsibility. Employees are encouraged to be involved in the organization.

Employees are more strongly motivated because their **status** and **recognition** needs are better met than with earlier models.

The supportive approach is not about money, but about the way people are treated at work. A supportive manager helps employees solve problems and accomplish their work. However, some managers may *agree* with the model but *not actually practice it* at work.

This model is followed widely, especially in the West, because it responds to employee drives for complex needs. It is especially useful in **production** work places. Employees in developing countries are aware of management practices around the world and are demanding more modern approaches.

COLLEGIAL MODEL

Collegial means people working together cooperatively. In this model, management builds a feeling of partnership with employees. The environment is open and people participate.

The **collegial model** is about team work. Managers are **coaches** to help build better teams. Employees are responsible – they feel obliged to others on the team to produce quality work. Employees must be self-disciplined. Many employees feel satisfied that they are making a worthwhile contribution. This leads to self actualization and moderate enthusiasm in the way they perform.

The **collegial model** is especially useful for **creative** work, like marketing or communications or in thinking environments, like education or planning.

THE SYSTEM MODEL

This is the most recent model. In this model, people want more than money, job security and cooperative teams. Employees today want trust, an ethical workplace, managers who show care and compassion and a workplace that has a sense of community.

The **system model** focuses on "identifying developing and managing the strengths within employees". Managers focus on "helping employees develop feelings of hope, optimism, self confidence, empathy, trustworthiness, esteem, courage, efficacy and resiliency."

In the system model, "Managers protect and nurture their employees…to develop a positive workplace culture which leads to organizational success and committed employees."

Both managers and employees need **social intelligence** in this model with managers as facilitators.

In the **system model**, managers and employees see the mutual benefits and obligations they share in the complex system (the organization). Everyone has psychological ownership for the organization, its products and services. Everyone feels possessive, responsible and "at home" in the organization.

Employees can reach a state of self motivation. Their highest order needs are met. They have passion and commitment to organizational goals, not just their own personal wants and needs.

TABLE 1 FIVE MODELS OF ORGANIZATIONAL BEHAVIOR (NEWSTROM 33)

	Autocratic	Custodial	Supportive	Collegial	System
Based on	Power	Economic resources	Leadership	Partnership	Trust, sharing
Managerial Orientation	Authority	Money	Support	Teamwork	Caring, compassion
Employee Orientation	Obedience	Security and benefits	Job performance	Responsible behavior	Psychological ownership
Employee psychological result	Dependence on boss	Dependence on organization	Participation	Self-discipline	Self motivation
Employees needs met	Subsistence (survival)	Security	Status and recognition	Self-actualization	Wide range
Performance result	Minimum	Passive cooperation	Awakened drives	Moderate enthusiasm	Passion and commitment to organizational goals

USIONS

Models have changed over time. The choice of model depends on employee needs and the situation. Any of the models work in *some* situations. There is a trend toward the newer models.

The Model used depends on the knowledge and skills of managers, the expectations of employees, the policies and ways of life in the organization and the nature of the work e.g. low skilled, high programmed work, temporary work, or intellectual work.

LEARNING

INTRODUCTION

If a manager wants to explain and predict human behaviour, he/she needs to understand how learning occurs or how people learn. So it is very very necessary to know the nature, process and principles of learning.

According to S.P. Robbins, "learning is any relatively permanent change in behaviour that occurs as a result of experience."

LEARNING PROCESS/NATURE

Theories of Learning: Learning is part of every one's life. In our life, all complex behavior is learned. Learning is defined as any relatively permanent change in behavior that occurs as a result of experience. Whenever any change occurs learning is taken place in the individual. If an individual behaves, reacts, responds as a result of experience which is different from others, a person has encountered some new learning experience in his life. This definition consists of the following four key elements:

i)Change process: Learning involves some change in oneself in terms of observable actions explicitly shown to others or change in one's attitude or thought process occur with oneself implicitly. Change may be good or bad or positive or negative from an organization point of view. If a person is happened to experience some negative incidents, that person will hold prejudices or bias or to restrict their output. On the contrary, if a person is encountering some good incident, that person is likely to hold positive attitude.

ii)Permanent change: Due to whatever exposure a person encounters, the impact what it generates may be long lasting and permanent. Hence, the change must be of relatively permanent. If change occurs due to fatigue or alcohol consumption or temporary adaptation, it may be vanished once the goal is achieved.

iii)Setting behavioral actions: Explicit changes occurring in behavior is the main goal of learning process. A change in an individual's thought process or attitudes without any changes in any explicit behavior will not be considered as learning process.

iv)Need for meaningful experiences: Some form of experiences is necessary for learning. Experience may be acquired directly through observation or practice. If experience results in a relatively permanent change in behavior, one can confidently say that learning has taken place.
Theories of Learning: There are three types of learning theories. These theories are classical conditioning, operant conditioning and social learning.

FACTORS AFFECTING LEARNING

- Motivation of the learner
- Mental set of the learner

- Nature of Learning Material
- Practice
- Environment

CLASSICAL CONDITIONING THEORY

Russian physiologist Ivan Pavlov developed classical conditioning theory. When he was doing a research on the chemical properties of saliva of dog, he noticed accidentally that the dog started salivating the moment hearing the sound of a door of cupboard clinging. Based on his observation, he wanted to do some experiment whether the dog can be conditioned to respond to any neutral stimuli. He used a simple surgical procedure to operate the salivary glands of a dog to measure accurately the amount of saliva.

Pavlov's Experiment: Pavlov conducted his experiment in three stages.

Stage I: When Pavlov presented the dog with a piece of meat, the dog exhibited a noticeable increase in salivation. The meat is unconditional stimulus and salivation is unconditional response.

Stage II: In this stage, the dog was not given a peace of meat but only exposed to a sound of ringing bell; the dog did not salivate to the mere sound of a ringing bell.

Stage III: Pavlov decided to link both the presentation of meat and the ringing of a bell one after the other with an interval of 5 minutes. After repeatedly hearing the bell before getting the meat, the dog began to salivate as soon the bell rang. There is an association or link between meat and ringing a bell. After repeating the association between meat and ringing a bell, the dog started salivating merely at the sound of the bell, even if no food was offered. The dog is now conditioned to respond to a sound of a bell and started salivating. This is called classical conditioning process.

Thus, classical condition is defined as the formation of S-R link (Stimulus-Response) or habit between a conditioned stimulus and a conditioned response through the repeated paring of conditioned stimulus with an unconditioned stimulus.

In this experiment, the meat is unconditioned stimulus, and the expected response that is, salivating to the meat is called as unconditioned response. The sound of a bell is a neutral stimulus which does not have any property to elicit salivation, is called as conditioned stimulus. Although it was originally neutral, if the bell was paired with meat (unconditioned stimulus) it acquired the same property as meat eliciting the salivation.

The sound of a bell produced salivation when presented alone. This is called conditioned response, that is, now the dog is conditioned to respond to the sound of a bell. Learning conditioned response involves building up an association between a conditioned stimulus and unconditioned stimulus. When the stimuli, one is natural and the other one neutral are paired, the neutral one becomes a conditioned stimulus and hence takes on the properties of the unconditioned stimulus.

APPLICATION OF CLASSICAL CONDITIONING PRINCIPLES AT WORK

Whenever President or Vice-President of Corporate Office visits factory site the employees in the shop floor will more attentive at work and look more prim, proper and active in their work life. It is quite natural that top management personnel visit (Unconditioned Stimulus) evoking or eliciting a desired response- being prim and proper at work from the employees (Unconditioned Response). The routine cleaning of windows or floor of the administrative office will be neutral stimulus never evoking any response from the employees. If the visit of the top management personnel is associated with such cleaning process, eventually the employees would turn on their best output and look prim and active the moment windows and floor are being cleaned up. The employees had learned to associate the cleaning of the windows with a visit from the head office. The cleaning process (conditioned stimulus) evoked attentive and active work behavior (conditioned response). Similarly, Christmas Carols songs bring pleasant memories of childhood as these songs are being associated with the festive Christmas Spirit.
Classical conditioning is passive. It is elicited in response to a specific, identifiable event.

OPERANT CONDITIONING

Operant conditioned principle is proposed by B.F. Skinner, an American Psychologist. It is a type of conditioning in which desired voluntary behavior leads to a reward or prevent a punishment. Operant conditioning principle emphasizes strongly that the behavior of an individual is a function of its consequences. If the consequences are pleasant, the behavior associated with such consequences will be repeated again and again. If the consequences are unpleasant, the behavior will be in extinct. The rationale behind this theory is that people learn to behave in order to get something they want or to avoid something they don't want. Operant condition is learned process. The tendency to repeat such behaviour is influenced by the reinforcement or lack of reinforcement brought about by the consequences of the behavior. The proper reinforcement strengthens a behavior and increases the likelihood that it will be repeated.
Skinner's Experiment: Skinner developed an apparatus to conduct a series of learning experiment using rats. He named that apparatus as Skinner's Box which has certain features such as a lever, bowl, light, water container etc. A highly deprived rat is placed in the box. Once a rat nudges or touches or hits the lever attached in the corner of the box, a piece of food pellet is dropped in the bowl. By trial and error, the rat learns that hitting the lever is followed by getting a food pellet in the bowl. Skinner coined the term operant response to any behavioral act such as pressing or hitting or nudging the lever that has some effect on the environment. Thus in a typical experiment with a skinner box, hitting or pressing the lever is an operant response, and the increased rate of lever hitting or pressing that occurs when the response is followed by a pellet of food exemplifies operant conditioning.

APPLICATION OF OPERANT CONDITIONING IN WORK LIFE

If a sales person who hits the assigned target of sales quota will be reinforced with a suitable attractive reward, the chances of hitting further sales target in future will be exemplified. Skinner argued that creating pleasant consequences (giving attractive rewards) to follow specific forms of behavior (hitting sales target) would increase the frequency of that behavior. People will most likely engage in desired behaviors if they are positively reinforced for doing so. Rewards are most effective if they immediately follow the desired response. In addition, behavior that is not

rewarded is less likely to be repeated. A commissioned sales person wanting to earn a sizeable income finds that doing so is contingent on generating high sales in his territory.

COGNITIVE LEARNING THEORY

Cognition refers to an individual's thoughts, knowledge, interpretations, understandings or views about oneself and his/her environment. Based on it cognitive theory argues that the person tries to formhis/her cognitive structure in memory, which preserves and organizes all information relating to the events that may occur in learning situation. Here an experiment was conducted on a monkey by Kohler. Kohler presented two sticks to a monkey in a cage. Both sticks were too short to reach a banana lying outside cage. This produced an experience, or say, cognition, insight monkey. What monkey did without any prior exposure, joined both sticks together and pulled the banana inside the cage. Clearly learning took place inside the mind of monkey. Thus, the learning process involved in this case is putting or organizing bits of information in a new manner perceived inside the mind. This type of learning is very imp in organizational behaviour for changing attitudes by the individuals.

SOCIAL LEARNING THEORY

People learn through both observation and direct experience, which is called as social learning theory. Individual learn by observing what happens to other people and just by being told about something, as well as by direct experiences. By observing people around us, mostly from parents, teachers, peers, films and television performers, bosses, we learn new behavior pattern.

The following four processes are vital to determine the influence that a model will have on an individual.

i)Attention Process: People learn from a model only when they recognize and pay attention to its critical features. People tend to be most influenced by models that are attractive, repeatedly available similar to us in our estimation.
ii)Retention Process: A model's influence will depend on how well the individual remembers the model's action after the model is no longer readily available.
iii)Motor Reproduction Process: After a person has seen a new behavior by observing the model, the watching must be converted to doing. This process then demonstrates that the individual can perform the modeled activities.
iv)Reinforcement Process: Individual will be motivated to exhibit they modeled behavior if positive incentives or rewards are provided. Behavior that is positively reinforced will be given more attention, learned better and performed more often.